The Word Became Flesh

John 1:1–18 · Luke 1–2 · Mark 2 and 4 · John 8:58

The big idea: The eternal Word, who was with God and was God, became flesh. Born of a virgin in Bethlehem, Jesus is Immanuel, God with us. Grown to manhood, he forgave sins, ruled the sea, took God's own name, and accepted worship.

Before you meet: Read

John 1:1–18 | Luke 2:1–20 | Mark 4:35–41

Open (5 minutes)

Before you started this study, who did you think Jesus was? Where did that idea come from?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"And the Word became _____ and dwelt among us, and we have seen his glory." *(John 1:14)*

"They shall call his name Immanuel" (which means, God _____ us). *(Matthew 1:23)*

"Who then is this, that even the wind and the _____ obey him?" *(Mark 4:41)*

"Truly, truly, I say to you, before _____ was, I am." *(John 8:58)*

Discuss

1. John says the Word became flesh. What does it tell you about God that he came himself rather than only sending a message? *John 1:1–14*

2. The first to hear the news were shepherds on the night shift. Why do you think God announced his Son to them? *Luke 2:8–20*

3. The disciples were more afraid after the storm was calmed than during it. Why? *Mark 4:35–41*

4. Which of Jesus' claims or actions strikes you as the strongest evidence that he is God? *Mark 2:5–12; John 8:58; 20:28*

Memory verse

"And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we have seen his glory, glory as of the only Son from the Father, full of grace and truth."

John 1:14

Pray

Worship Jesus as God the Son, who came to us himself. Thank him that though he was rich, for your sake he became poor.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 37

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read John 1:1–14 and Mark 4:35–41 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Matthew 16:13–17:8, and begin the Gospel of Mark).

Main points to land

1. Jesus is the fulfillment of every promise in the story so far. He is Immanuel, God with us (Matthew 1:23; 2 Corinthians 1:20).
2. The eternal Word, who was with God and was God, took a true human nature by the virgin conception and was born in Bethlehem (John 1:1, 14; Luke 1:35; 2:7).
3. Jesus is truly God: he forgave sins, ruled the sea, took God's name, and received worship (Mark 2:5–12; 4:41; John 8:58; 20:28).

Answer key (Observe)

1. flesh
2. with
3. sea
4. Abraham

Questions people will ask

If Jesus is God, who was he praying to? Is he the Father?

No. There is one God in three Persons: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. The Son is with God and is God (John 1:1), so he can pray to the Father without being the Father. Whoever has seen Jesus has seen the Father (John 14:9) because the Son perfectly reveals him, not because they are the same Person.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you for sending your Son, the Word made flesh. Thank you that he came himself, to a manger and a cross, for people like us. Give us eyes to see his glory, full of grace and truth, and hearts to worship him. Amen.